Learning Objective 4.2: I can describe PAM theory and identify the pulse-shaping, symbol-rate, and bandwidth trade-offs.

Learning Objective 4.3: I can apply matched filtering and symbol-timing recovery to a received PAM signal.

Show your work. Write a **Documentation** line at the end (**None** if you did not collaborate).

1. **Fitting a channel.** A telemetry link must fit a 25 kHz channel and carry at least 32 kb/s. Use RRC pulse shaping, with bandwidth $B = (1+\alpha)R_s$.

   (a) With 2-PAM and $\alpha = 0.35$, find the largest symbol rate that fits and the bit rate it carries. Does it meet the requirement?

   $$R_s = \frac{B}{1+\alpha} = \frac{25\text{ kHz}}{1.35} = 18.5\text{ kbaud}$$

   One bit per symbol gives 18.5 kb/s, which is short of 32 kb/s.

   R_s: 18.5 kbaud

   meets it? no

   (b) Switch to 4-PAM at the same α. Find the bit rate, and use Lesson 3's curves to state how much more E_b/N_0 the link needs for a bit error rate of 10^{-5}.

   $$R_b = 2 \times 18.5 = 37.0\text{ kb/s}$$

   which meets the requirement. 2-PAM needs 9.6 dB and 4-PAM needs 13.4 dB at 10^{-5}, so 3.8 dB more.

   R_b: 37.0 kb/s

   extra: 3.8 dB

   (c) Keep 2-PAM instead and send 32 kbaud. What roll-off would fit 25 kHz? Explain why that answer rules out this option.

   $$1+\alpha = \frac{25}{32} = 0.78 \quad \Rightarrow \quad \alpha = -0.22$$

   The roll-off cannot be negative: the narrowest any pulse can make the signal is $B = R_s = 32$ kHz at $\alpha = 0$, which is wider than the channel.

   impossible

2. **Setting up the transmit filter.** A flowgraph runs at `samp_rate` = 48 kHz and sends 2-PAM at 4.8 kbaud with $\alpha = 0.25$.

   (a) Find the samples per symbol and the occupied bandwidth.

   $$\texttt{sps} = \frac{48\text{ kHz}}{4.8\text{ kbaud}} = 10, \qquad B = 1.25 \times 4.8 = 6.0\text{ kHz}$$

   `sps`: 10

   B: 6.0 kHz

   (b) Write the `firdes.root_raised_cosine` call for the transmit taps, with a filter 11 symbols long, and name the block that uses them and its interpolation.

   `firdes.root_raised_cosine(10, 48000, 4800, 0.25, 110)`, in that order: gain `sps`, sample rate, symbol rate, α, and `11*sps` taps. The taps go in an Interpolating FIR Filter with interpolation 10.

   (c) A teammate wants 4.4 kbaud at the same sample rate. Explain why the flowgraph cannot do this as built, and give one way to fix it.

   $48/4.4 = 10.9$ samples per symbol, and the interpolating filter needs an integer interpolation. Change the sample rate to an integer multiple of the symbol rate, such as 44 kHz for $\texttt{sps} = 10$, or choose a symbol rate that divides 48 kHz, such as 4 kbaud.

   (d) The teammate shortens the filter to `2*sps` taps to save computation. What happens to the spectrum, and why?

   The filter truncates the pulse to two symbols. Cutting the pulse off abruptly in time spreads its spectrum, so the sidelobes outside $\pm B/2$ rise and the signal spills into the neighboring channels, which is the problem RRC shaping exists to solve.

3. **Reading an eye.** A QT GUI Eye Sink shows a 2-PAM signal at sps = 8 after the receive filter. The eye is widest open 3 samples after the start of each symbol period, where the traces cluster at ± 0.8 with a spread of ± 0.2 around each level.

   (a) Where should the receiver sample, and what is the eye opening there as a fraction of the ideal gap from -0.8 to $+0.8$?

   75%

   Sample 3 samples into each symbol. The innermost traces are at $0.8 - 0.2 = 0.6$ and -0.6, so the opening is

   $$\frac{0.6 - (-0.6)}{0.8 - (-0.8)} = \frac{1.2}{1.6} = 75\%$$

   (b) For each change below, say how the eye changes: (i) the noise doubles; (ii) the receiver drops its filter; (iii) the receiver samples 4 samples away from the best instant.

   (i) The traces spread vertically and the opening shrinks; at twice the spread, ± 0.4, it falls to $(0.4 - (-0.4))/1.6 = 50\%$. (ii) Noise across the whole sample bandwidth returns and the single transmit RRC leaves ISI, so the traces miss the levels and the eye nearly closes. (iii) Four samples is half a symbol, so the receiver samples at the zero crossings and the decisions are no better than guesses.

   (c) In words, explain why a smaller roll-off makes the receiver more sensitive to timing error.

   A smaller α gives a narrower spectrum, which means a longer pulse with larger tails. Away from the symbol instant those tails from many neighbors add up to more ISI, so the eye's waist is narrower and a given timing error closes it more.

4. **The matched filter.** The L9 matched-filter flowgraph runs at `samp_rate` = 32 kHz, `sps` = 8, and $\alpha = 0.35$.

   (a) The transmitter uses an RRC filter. What filter should the receiver use, and why does that choice also give zero ISI?

   The same RRC filter. The matched filter is the transmit pulse reversed in time, and an RRC pulse is symmetric, so it is its own match. The two RRC filters in cascade make a raised cosine, which is zero at every other symbol instant.

   (b) Before the receive filter, the noise fills the full 32 kHz the samples represent. Afterward, it occupies about R_s. Estimate the noise reduction in dB.

   9.0 dB

   $$10 \log_{10} \frac{32 \text{ kHz}}{4 \text{ kHz}} = 10 \log_{10} 8 = 9.0 \text{ dB}$$

   (c) A classmate puts a full raised-cosine filter at the transmitter and no filter at the receiver. The eye at the receiver has zero ISI. Explain what is still wrong with this design.

   The receiver passes all the noise across the 32 kHz the samples represent, about 9 dB more than the matched filter would, so the eye is noisier and the error rate is higher at the same transmit power. Zero ISI is necessary but not sufficient; the RRC split gets zero ISI and the best noise rejection together.

5. **Timing recovery.** A 2-PAM receiver at 4 kbaud uses Keep 1 in N to pick one sample per symbol, starting at the center of the eye. Its sample clock is 50 ppm fast relative to the transmitter's.

   (a) How many symbols, and how many seconds, until the sampling point has drifted half a symbol, to the zero crossings?

   Each symbol the sampling point moves 50×10^{-6} of a symbol, so

   $$N = \frac{0.5}{50 \times 10^{-6}} = 10{,}000 \text{ symbols}$$
   $$t = \frac{10{,}000}{4000} = 2.5 \text{ s}$$

   symbols: 10,000

   time: 2.5 s

   (b) You replace Keep 1 in N with a Symbol Sync block that uses a Gardner timing error detector. Explain, in words, how the Gardner detector tells whether the sampling is early or late, and why it needs at least 2 samples per symbol.

   It looks at the sample halfway between two symbols. When the timing is right, a transition between opposite symbols crosses zero exactly at that midpoint; if the midpoint sample has the sign of the earlier symbol, the sampling is early, and if it has the sign of the later one, it is late. It needs a sample at each symbol instant and one halfway between, which is 2 samples per symbol.

   (c) The Symbol Sync output jitters around ± 1 even with little noise. Which parameter should change, in which direction, and what is the trade-off?

   Lower the loop bandwidth. A narrower loop averages the timing error over more symbols, so the sampling instant jitters less, but the loop locks more slowly and follows a drifting clock less closely.

Documentation: _____